



Cricketers Shikha Pandey and Swapnil Asnodkar, along with GCA President Vipul Phadke, discuss the future of Goa cricket. The session was moderated by Shayan Acharya. EMMANUAL YOGINI

THE ROAD AHEAD FOR GOA CRICKET

India international Shikha Pandey: "The Goa Women's Premier League last year was one of its kind. Before that, 2016 was the last time we played a tournament of that sort. Unfortunately, we don't have club cricket for women in Goa.

There were a few girls who caught the eye of the selectors. They gradually moved to the Under-19 and

Under-23 teams. For women to have that opportunity to play under lights was really good. When you have a cricketer from Goa who is consistently in the national set-up, be it an NCA camp, or Under-23 or Emerging India camp, you gather a lot of information and standards that are to be set. Then you come back to the team and tell everyone else that, 'This is what we are supposed to be doing and this is what I learnt there.' That is something which is missing. With Suyash [Prabhudessai] being there in RCB, I am sure he must be coming back and talking to a lot of cricketers."



K. C. Vijaya Kumar, Sports Editor, The Hindu, in conversation with Olympic hockey gold medallist, Mervyn Fernandes, Indian badminton player Anura Prabhudesai and International windsurfer Dayne Coelho.

EMMANUAL YOGINI

BUILDING ON THE LEGACY OF THE NATIONAL GAMES

Mervyn Fernandes, a member of the 1980 gold medal-winning hockey team: "Football is the most popular sport in Goa, but it's important to recognize the contributions of other sports like hockey. Olympians from Goa, including Mary D'Souza, have made significant strides in hockey. Despite being less in the spotlight, efforts have been made to promote and popularize hockey. Recent initiatives, such as hosting the Sub Junior and Junior Nationals on Astroturf, suggest that hockey is gaining ground."